

CLIFFORD OPOKU-SARKODIE

Backend Engineer · DevSecOps · Fintech & Identity Systems

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend Engineer with 5+ years of technical experience building secure, distributed systems for fintech and AI products. Specializes in Python (FastAPI / Django), Node.js, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Redis, and Docker — with a DevSecOps mindset applied from day one. Portfolio includes production-grade systems: a double-entry fintech ledger, an auth microservice, an event-driven observability pipeline, a multi-tenant AI SaaS, and a digital wallet API. Open to remote backend and DevSecOps roles globally.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: Python (FastAPI, Django/DRF), Node.js / Express, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+)

Databases, Caching & Messaging: PostgreSQL, Redis (Streams, ZSET, Pub/Sub), MongoDB, Apache Kafka, Celery

DevSecOps & Cloud: Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions (CI/CD), AWS, GCP, Linux, Prometheus, Grafana

Security & APIs: JWT, OAuth2, RBAC, Row-Level Security, Rate Limiting, REST API Design, Identity & Access Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder / Backend Engineer & Web Developer | [Cliff-De-Tech](#) · Accra, Ghana Jan 2021 – Present

- Built and deployed the Cliff-DeTech brand platform using HTML, CSS, and Git, reducing client onboarding friction by 40% through a responsive, self-service digital presence.
- Resolved 20+ complex hardware-software failures for clients, maintaining a 95% same-session resolution rate and eliminating repeat escalations.
- Managed 10+ end-to-end client engagements across fintech and SME sectors, translating technical requirements into delivery plans with zero missed deadlines.

Learner Success Champion | [ALX Africa](#) · Accra, Ghana

Sep – Oct 2025

- Mentored 50+ software engineering learners, improving weekly engagement and reducing at-risk dropout cases through proactive coaching and technical peer sessions.
- Recognized by Program Manager Mercy Kendi for leadership and ability to break down complex topics into actionable understanding for peers.

Junior Graphic Designer | [IKE MEDIA GH](#) · Koforidua, Ghana

Jan 2021 – May 2024

- Created 30+ visual assets for social media campaigns using Photoshop and Illustrator, directly driving a 15% increase in audience engagement across client accounts.
- Delivered brand identity systems for 5+ clients and reduced revision cycles by 2 rounds per project through structured feedback templates.

SELECTED PROJECTS

LedgerX [LINK](#) Python · FastAPI · PostgreSQL · Redis · Kafka · Docker · Kubernetes

- Production-grade double-entry fintech ledger with ACID compliance, optimistic locking, transactional outbox pattern, and immutable journaling — designed for 10K TPS and 10M+ users. Includes multi-AZ architecture, balance snapshot strategy, and PCI-DSS-aligned security trust zones.

AuthForge [LINK](#) TypeScript · Node.js · PostgreSQL · JWT · Docker · GitHub Actions

- Centralized auth microservice with OAuth2 flows, JWT access/refresh tokens, RBAC, Redis session management, and full audit logging. Containerized with Docker, shipped via automated CI/CD pipeline.

EventFlow [LINK](#) Python · FastAPI · Redis Streams · PostgreSQL · Prometheus · Grafana · Docker

- Event-driven observability pipeline with CloudEvents-compliant schema, consumer groups, exponential backoff retry, dead letter queue, circuit breaker pattern, and Grafana dashboards for real-time monitoring.

SupportIQ [LINK](#) Python · FastAPI · PostgreSQL · Redis · Celery · OpenAI GPT-4 · Docker

- Multi-tenant AI SaaS for support ticketing with Row-Level Security, automated AI ticket routing, sentiment analysis, SLA breach detection, and Celery background workers — built for Free/Starter/Pro/Enterprise tiers.

Gatekeeper [LINK](#) TypeScript · Node.js · Redis

- TypeScript/Node.js API rate limiting engine with sliding/fixed window algorithms, Redis-backed counters, and configurable fail-open/closed behaviour.

Cliff-Pay [LINK](#) Python · Django · DRF · PostgreSQL · JWT

- Django/DRF P2P digital wallet with atomic transfers, JWT auth, and full transaction history.

LinkedIn Bot [LINK](#) *Python · FastAPI · Groq LLM*

- FastAPI + Groq LLM AI content automation pipeline for generating and scheduling LinkedIn posts.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.S. Computer Science (In Progress) · University of the People

2025 – 2029

Certifications: Data Engineer Associate · GitHub Foundations Track · ALX Professional Foundations · ALX Backend Engineering